

DAY 4

Communication Skills for Interviews

Student Handout Notes

Not just fluent English - clear ideas, confident delivery, professional behavior.

Clear answers

Confident voice

Professional words

Good listening

Positive body language

Practice-based improvement

Learning Outcome

By the end of this session, you should understand that communication is not only about speaking English. It is about expressing your ideas clearly, confidently, and professionally during interviews.

Use this handout to revise examples, practice answers, and check your own communication habits.

Slide 1 - Communication Skills for Interviews

Big Idea

In an interview, your answer is judged by both **content** and **delivery**.

A simple answer spoken clearly is better than a difficult answer spoken confusingly.

Common Myth

Communication means speaking fluent English with fancy words.

Many students become nervous because they think their English must be perfect.

Better Truth

Communication means the interviewer understands your idea clearly.

Simple English + clear structure + confidence = strong communication.

Example

Weak: *"I know many technical things but I cannot explain properly."*

Strong: *"I worked on a Python project where I collected data, cleaned it, and tested a simple model."*

Why strong? It is simple, specific, and easy to understand.

Remember

Good communication can support average technical skills, but poor communication can weaken even the best technical answer.

Slide 2 - Why Communication Matters

Companies test communication because employees must explain ideas, work in teams, write emails, attend meetings, and talk professionally.

Confidence - speak without fear

Clarity - explain your thinking

Professionalism - workplace behavior

First impression - greeting, smile, posture

Career growth - teamwork and leadership

Candidate	Technical Knowledge	Communication	Likely Interview Impact
A	95%	Cannot explain clearly	Interviewer may doubt practical ability.
B	80%	Explains confidently	Interviewer understands skills and potential.

Key Takeaway

Interviews do not test only what you know. They test **how well you communicate what you know**.

Knowledge in your mind has value only when you can express it clearly.

Slide 3 - What is Communication?

Communication is NOT only English

Communication means sending a message in a way that the receiver understands correctly.

English is only one language. Communication also includes listening, understanding, tone, body language, and confidence.

Speaking

Listening

Understanding

Confidence

Body Language

Tone

Bottle Example

You say: *"Bring me a bottle."*

Your friend brings a notebook.

You spoke, but communication failed because the message was not understood.

Interview Example

Question: *"Tell me your strength."*

Weak: *"I am good and hardworking."*

Strong: *"My strength is consistency. I prepared daily for my project review and submitted before the deadline."*

Can communication happen without speaking?

Yes. Eye contact, smile, handshake, facial expression, posture, gestures, and nodding also communicate.

Your communication begins before your first answer.

Slide 4 - Components of Effective Communication

Effective communication is a combination of small skills. Improve each part step by step.

Component	Meaning	Interview Example
Verbal	Words you choose.	"I completed a two-month internship in web development."
Tone	How your voice sounds: calm, nervous, rude, or confident.	Say "I know Python" calmly, not arrogantly.
Listening	Understand the question before answering.	"Could you please repeat the question?"
Confidence	Speak honestly without fear.	"I know the basics and I am willing to learn more."
Non-verbal	Communication without words.	Eye contact, posture, smile, natural gestures.
Clarity	Make your answer easy to understand.	"My project is an online library system that manages book issue and return."

Mini Practice

Complete this in two clear sentences:

1. My project is about _____.
2. My role was _____.

Slide 5 - The 7 C's of Communication

Use the 7 C's as a quality checklist for every interview answer.

7 C	Meaning	Weak Answer	Better Answer
Clear	Easy to understand.	"I did many things."	"I created the login page and connected it to the database."
Concise	Short but meaningful.	Long personal life story.	Name + education + skills + project + goal.
Concrete	Use facts/examples.	"I am hardworking."	"I coordinated a team of 10 students for a 200-participant event."
Correct	Correct grammar and information.	"I has completed internship."	"I have completed an internship."
Complete	Answer the full question.	"My project was an app."	"It was a food app; my role was UI and order page design."
Courteous	Polite and respectful.	"What?"	"Could you please repeat the question?"
Considerate	Use language suitable for the interviewer.	"Bro, that project was crazy."	"That project was challenging and improved my problem-solving skills."

Golden Rule

A good interview answer is clear, short, specific, correct, complete, polite, and suitable for the interviewer.

Slide 5 Practice - Make Answers Stronger

Weak Answer

"I am hardworking."

Problem: No evidence. It is not concrete.

Strong Answer

"I am hardworking. For example, during our college event, I helped manage registration for around 200 students and completed my duty on time."

Why strong? It includes example + number + responsibility.

Interview Question	Use This Structure	Sample Strong Answer
Tell me about yourself.	Present + skills + project + goal	"I am a final-year B.Tech student. I have worked on Python and web development projects, and I am interested in software roles."
What is your strength?	Strength + example + result	"My strength is consistency. I practiced coding daily for one month and improved my problem-solving speed."
What is your weakness?	Weakness + improvement action	"I used to feel nervous while speaking, but I am improving by recording my introductions and practicing daily."
Why should we hire you?	Skills + attitude + learning ability	"I have the required basic skills, I learn quickly, and I can work sincerely with a team."

Formula to Remember

Point + Example + Result

Example: *"My strength is teamwork. In my final-year project, I worked with four members and coordinated documentation. Because of teamwork, we submitted before the deadline."*

Slide 6 - Common Communication Mistakes

Small habits can make a good answer sound weak. Notice them and correct them during practice.

Speaking too fast

Speaking too softly

Too many fillers

Memorized answers

Interrupting

Looking down

Negative language

Very long answers

Mistake	Why It Hurts	Better Habit
Fillers: actually, basically, umm	Makes you sound unsure.	Pause silently for 1-2 seconds.
Speaking too fast	Interviewer may miss your point.	Speak slightly slower than normal.
Low voice	Shows nervousness or low confidence.	Speak clearly and audibly.
Memorized answer	Sounds robotic and fake.	Use natural words and real examples.
Negative language	Creates weak impression.	Use improvement-focused language.

Quick Classroom Activity

One student gives a 30-second introduction. Other students count fillers: *actually, basically, like, umm, means*.

Purpose: not to make fun - to become aware. Awareness is the first step to improvement.

Slide 7 - Professional Communication Tips

Professional communication does not mean difficult vocabulary. It means respectful and suitable vocabulary.

Avoid	Use Instead
Yeah	Yes / Yes, certainly.
Nope	No, I have not worked on that yet.
Okay	Sure / Certainly / Yes, I understand.
Wait	May I take a moment to think?
What?	Could you please repeat the question?
I don't know	I am not fully sure, but I can try to explain what I understand.
Whatever	I am flexible with that.
Like... you know...	Pause silently or remove it.

Useful Interview Phrases

- Good morning, sir/ma'am.
- Thank you for giving me this opportunity.
- Thank you for the question.
- May I take a moment to think?
- I have not worked on that yet, but I am willing to learn.
- In my project, my role was...

Slide 8 - Interview Activity: Spot the Mistake

Question: **Tell me about yourself.** Read each answer and identify the communication problem.

Answer	Main Mistake	Improved Version
"Actually... basically... my name is Rohan... umm... like... I am interested in coding..."	Too many fillers. No structure. Sounds nervous.	"My name is Rohan Sharma. I am a final-year B.Tech student in Computer Science. I have worked on Python and web projects, and I am interested in software development roles."
Long answer about birthplace, family, hobbies, childhood, and many unrelated details.	Too long. Not focused on job or skills.	"My name is Priya Singh. I am pursuing B.Tech in ECE. I completed one internship in embedded systems and worked on a smart home automation project."
"My name is Aman." Then silence.	Too short. Not complete.	"My name is Aman Verma. I am a final-year Mechanical Engineering student. I have worked on AutoCAD design and I am interested in manufacturing and design roles."

Best Self-Introduction Structure

1. Name
2. Education
3. Skills or project
4. Internship or achievement
5. Career interest

Slide 9 - Communication Checklist

Use this checklist before every interview answer.

Before Speaking	While Speaking	After Speaking
Listen carefully. Think for 1-2 seconds. Smile naturally. Understand the question fully.	Maintain natural eye contact. Speak clearly. Avoid fillers. Use examples. Stay confident and polite.	Stop when the answer is complete. Smile calmly. Wait for the next question. Do not over-explain.

Strong Answer Pattern

Clear Start: Answer the question directly.

Useful Middle: Add one example or detail.

Confident Stop: End the answer and wait.

Too Long

If you keep talking after the answer is complete, the interviewer may lose interest.

Too Short

If your answer is only one word, the interviewer cannot understand your ability.

Best Balance

Give enough information to answer the question, but not so much that the answer becomes confusing.

Slide 10 - Key Takeaways and Homework

Today's Learning

- Communication is much more than English.
- Good communication creates confidence.
- The 7 C's make answers professional.
- Recruiters judge delivery as much as content.
- Practice is the only shortcut.

Homework: 1-Minute Introduction Video

Record a one-minute self-introduction. Watch it yourself. Then record again after correcting mistakes.

Observe: fillers, eye contact, smile, confidence, pace, clarity, and posture.

Self-Check Question	My Observation
Did I use too many fillers?	
Was my voice clear?	
Did I look confident?	
Was my answer too long or too short?	
Did I give at least one example?	

Your resume gets you the interview. Your communication gets you the job.

Practice Sheet - Build Your Interview Introduction

One-Minute Self-Introduction Template

Good morning. My name is _____. I am pursuing _____ from _____.

I have worked on projects related to _____. My key skills are _____.

I am interested in _____ roles. I am a sincere learner and I am looking forward to starting my professional career.

Write Your Own Introduction

Answer Formula: Point + Example + Result

Point: My strength is _____.

Example: For example, I _____.

Result: Because of this, _____.

My Strength Answer Practice

Final Reminder

Do not focus on perfect English. Focus on clear, confident, respectful communication.